

Village Wellbeing Scoring System - Stakeholder Summary

Purpose

This framework helps villages and partners understand two things together:

1. How people are doing (individual wellbeing)
2. How village systems are performing (resources and infrastructure)
3. Helps generate actionable insights for better decision making, and lowers the cost of deriving actionable insights

The result is a practical decision tool for planning investments, targeting interventions, and tracking progress.

Strategy Layer for Insights

The strategy layer is designed to assess where households and villages are in their wellbeing journey and turn the underlying data into decision-support insights for evidence-based planning and action.

It evaluates:

- What people currently have (assets, capabilities, access)
- What they need (gaps, vulnerabilities, constraints)
- What potentials are possible (latent capacities, regenerative opportunities)

What Is Measured

Level 1: Individual Wellbeing (7 spheres)

- **Physical:** Examines overall vitality, health, and how well the body acts as a vehicle for consciousness through diet, rest, and activity.
- **Occupational:** Examines whether people have meaningful, stable, and dignified livelihood pathways. In the current pilot, this sphere is operationalized primarily through income, savings, debt resilience, asset ownership, and financial or enterprise literacy.
- **Emotional:** Evaluates the ability to understand, process, and express feelings, mapping relationships to manage stress and nurture emotional intelligence.
- **Social:** Focuses on the strength of societal cohesion, healthy communication, and the networks of mutual support within the community.
- **Environmental:** Assesses the harmony between the community and nature, measuring how living spaces and resource usage affect the health of the Earth.
- **Intellectual:** Examines continuous learning, problem-solving capabilities, and the active pursuit of new skills and knowledge to adapt to life's challenges.
- **Spiritual:** Explores the deeper connection to purpose, ethical values, and the realization of interconnectedness (Oneness) beyond the material self.

Each sphere is built from clearly defined indicators with transparent scoring rules.

Level 2: Village Resource Adequacy (11 sub-domains)

- Land
- Water
- Forestry and Timber
- Energy and Fuel
- Housing
- Community Infrastructure
- Mobility and Transportation
- Agriculture and Food
- Business and Commercial
- Income and Expenditure
- Personal and Household Items

How Scoring Works

- All indicators are normalized to a 0-1 scale.
- Sphere and sub-domain scores are calculated using **simple averages** of valid indicators.
 - *Rationale:* A simple average ensures no single deficit overwhelmingly penalizes the entire category (unlike multiplicative formulas). For example, if a village has high agricultural yields but lower business income, the resilience provided by agriculture is still accurately reflected in a blended average rather than zeroed out.
- Individual scores are aggregated to village-level wellbeing scores.
- Village resource scores are calculated from household and village data.

Combined Village Sustainability Score

The pilot uses a weighted integration:

$$\text{Village Sustainability} = (\text{Individual Wellbeing} \times 0.6) + (\text{Village Resource Adequacy} \times 0.4)$$

Rationale: the final objective is human wellbeing; infrastructure and resources are enabling conditions.

Interpretation Bands

- 0.80-1.00: Excellent (maintain and replicate)
- 0.60-0.79: Good (strengthen targeted areas)
- 0.30-0.59: Moderate (intervention needed)
- 0.00-0.29: Low (urgent action required)

How Results Should Be Used

1. Prioritize Interventions

- Low individual + low resource score: structural investment needed
- Low individual + adequate resources: access, distribution, or social-program gap
- Adequate individual + low resources: preventive action before decline

2. Improve Accountability

- Scoring logic is explicit and auditable
- Missing data handling is predefined
- Threshold sources are documented

3. Compare Fairly Over Time

- Same scoring method enables year-on-year tracking
- Supports village-to-village benchmarking when data quality is sufficient

Recommended Dashboard Views

- Overall village sustainability score card
- 7-sphere wellbeing radar/spider chart
- 11 sub-domain resource bar chart
- Deficit/surplus flag table
- Priority action list with owner and timeline

Decision Value for Stakeholders

- Village leaders: clear priorities and local action planning
- Government: evidence-based allocation and monitoring
- Donors/NGOs: transparent gap targeting and impact tracking
- Technical teams: stable, implementation-ready scoring logic
- **The Community (Why Participate):** In the current pilot run, participation yields actionable insights on a local dashboard. In the future, as the system develops beyond key maturity thresholds, it will scale into a full AI advisory platform linked to marketplaces and extensive knowledge resources. The ultimate goal is community self-empowerment—these compounding benefits serve as a powerful incentive for villages to actively engage and participate in the framework.